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Maths puzzles for early finishers

Early Finisher Puzzles

Primary 1

20 single-page puzzles
Every puzzle checks itself
One star and two star pages
Teacher answer key included

This pack belongs to

_____

[Publisher line: wording to be confirmed by the owner]

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- Print this PDF and photocopy any page for the pupils and staff of the school named above.
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Notes

The licence is for the edition bought. The school name shown on each page is set when the pack is made.

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Teacher notes (DRAFT)

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What this is

Twenty single-page maths puzzles for Primary 1 pupils who finish their work early. Each page stands alone, so you can hand out one page or keep a tray of pages. The pupil needs no help to start.

Stars

One star pages practise a topic as it is usually taught (10 pages). Two star pages use the same topics with two steps or two clues to combine (10 pages). Pages can be used in any order.

Every page checks itself

The boxed strip at the foot of each page tells the pupil how to check. The check shows that something is wrong. It does not give the answer.

- **Code word.** The answers give letters that spell a word. The strip gives no hint of the word. Each word can be spelt from its letters in one way only, so answers in the wrong boxes never make another word.
- **Colour by code.** Each answer is found in a key of five numbers and the part is coloured with that crayon. The pupil counts the parts of each colour and compares with the box on the page; matching parts must share a colour.
- **Route.** The line must reach FINISH through the stated number of boxes.
- **Logic grid and queue.** Each number, price or child has a letter; the letters, read down the list, must spell a word. P1-04 and P1-07 list one number or child too many; its letter is a decoy.
- **Total.** The whole count must make the stated total (P1-20 adds a second sum for the two questions).

Marking is not needed. To spot-check, look only at the check strip.

How the checks were tested

For every page, a script tried every single wrong answer (any other value in the page's range) and every wrong arrangement of the logic pages. The check rejected at least 95% of them on every page. A wrong answer that happens to spell any English word from a list of about 129 000 words counts as not rejected.

Teacher notes: using the pages (DRAFT)

Using the pages

- **Time.** Most pages take 5 to 15 minutes; the colour-by-code pages (P1-01, P1-12, P1-14) take longer because pupils colour a picture. Pupils need their own crayons (five colours: yellow, red, blue, green, orange). The outline is printed black and white; the colour words in the key are what the pupil follows.
- **If the check fails.** The pupil goes back, looks for the slip, and asks a friend or you if still stuck.
- **When to use.** Some topics are usually taught later in the year: P1-03, P1-05, P1-06, P1-12, P1-13, P1-15, P1-16, P1-17, P1-18, P1-19, P1-20. P1-06 uses o'clock and half past; P1-18 reads times to 5 minutes and is usually used late in the year. Check your scheme of work before giving out these pages.
- **Stars.** One star: one skill, as usually taught. Two stars: the same topics with two steps or two clues to combine.

Photocopying

All pages are black and white with solid lines, so they copy cleanly. Each page is one side only; the back of a copy stays blank. Pupils write on the page: the boxes are large for young hands. Use A4 and print at 100% (actual size); on P1-17 a real ruler matches the drawn ruler only at 100%.

What is in this pack

Part	Pages	Photocopy for pupils?
Cover	1	No
Photocopy licence	1	No
Teacher notes	2	No
Contents	1	No
Puzzle pages P1-01 to P1-20	20	Yes
Complete pack to print	**25**	The teacher answer key is a separate file.

Contents

Page	Puzzle	Topic	Tier
P1-01	Colour the Rocket	Place value: tens and ones	1 star
P1-02	Mystery Numbers	Numbers to 100: tens digit, ones digit, more and less	2 stars
P1-03	Fair Shares	Sharing equally and making equal groups (within 20)	1 star
P1-04	Sticker Grid	Comparing numbers to 100 (more, fewer, greatest, smallest)	2 stars
P1-05	Times Code	Multiplication within 40: groups of, and the missing number	2 stars
P1-06	What Time Is It?	Time: o'clock and half past	1 star
P1-07	The Queue	Ordinal numbers: 1st to 5th, next to	2 stars
P1-08	Make Twelve	Addition within 20	1 star
P1-09	Magic Square	Adding three 1-digit numbers	2 stars
P1-10	Take Away Code	Subtraction within 20; missing numbers	1 star
P1-11	Big Number Sums	Add and subtract within 100	2 stars
P1-12	Colour the House	Shapes: corners	1 star
P1-13	Equal Groups	Multiplication: equal groups	1 star
P1-14	Colour the Ice Cream	Counting in 2s, 5s and 10s	2 stars
P1-15	Coin Purses	Money: counting coins in cents (up to $1)	1 star
P1-16	Shop Prices	Money: dollars, more and less	2 stars
P1-17	How Long?	Length: measure in centimetres	1 star
P1-18	Clock Time	Time to 5 minutes: 1 hour and half an hour later	2 stars
P1-19	Shape Count	2D shapes: rectangle, triangle, circle, half circle, quarter circle	1 star
P1-20	Fruit Graph	Picture graphs: read, complete and answer	2 stars

Pages are independent. Pick any page.